



ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Reduced Adverb Clauses

Cause & Effect + Perfect Participles

A Complete Guide for Intermediate Learners

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Cause Clauses

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WHAT WE WILL COVER

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3 quizzes with full answers

01 | CAUSE CONJUNCTIONS: As / Since / Because / While



As / Since / Because / While (cause & effect) are OMITTED when reducing.
Use **V-ing** or **having V3/ed**.

ACTIVE

Conjunction + S + BE + V-ing
→ **V-ing**

Because she is a mother now, she has more responsibilities.

→ **Being a mother now, she has more responsibilities.**

Because she needed some money to buy a book, Sue cashed a check.

→ **Needing some money to buy a book, Sue cashed a check.**

ACTIVE (simple)

Conjunction + S + V
→ **V-ing** (conj. omitted)

While she accepts that he's not perfect, she does actually quite like the man.

→ **Accepting that he's not perfect, she does actually quite like the man.**

I didn't tell her he was late since I didn't want to cause any alarm.

→ **I didn't tell her he was late, not wanting to cause her any alarm.**

PERFECT

Conjunction + S + had + V3
→ **having V3**

02 | NEGATIVE REDUCTIONS: not + V-ing / not having V3

RULE: In negative reductions, place **NOT** directly before the participle (V-ing or having V3).

not + V-ing

Because I don't know her phone number, I can't call her.

Not knowing her phone number, I can't call her.

As he didn't know the language, he found it hard to get work.

Not knowing the language, he found it hard to get work.

not + having V3

Because she hadn't studied well, she failed the exam.

Not having studied well, she failed the exam.

Not having received any letters from her, I wrote the letter.

Not having received any letters from her, I wrote the letter. ✓ (already reduced)

03 | 'being' + Adj & If / Unless / As if Reductions

If adverb clause has 'to be + adjective', use (being) + adjective. 'Being' is optional.

Since she is suitable for the vacant post, she is lucky.

→ **Being suitable for the vacant post, she is lucky.**

→ **Suitable for the vacant post, she is lucky.** (being dropped entirely — also correct)

 Reductions also work with: if, unless, as if, whether...or (keep the conjunction!)

Unless we are paid fairly, we will go on a strike.

→ **Unless paid fairly, we will go on a strike.**

They were running hurriedly, as if they were being chased by someone.

→ **They were running hurriedly, as if being chased by someone.**



04 | HAVING V3 — Active Perfect Participle



Use 'having V3' when the adverb clause event happened BEFORE the main clause event. Shows sequence in time.

Because/Since/As + S + had + V3 → Having + V3 (conjunction omitted)

#	ADVERB CLAUSE	REDUCED (Having V3)
1	Because I injured my back yesterday, I now have difficulty walking.	Having injured my back yesterday, I now have difficulty walking.
2	Having read the instructions, he snatched up the fire extinguisher.	(already reduced — correct ✓)
3	Having failed twice, he didn't want to try again.	(already reduced — correct ✓)
4	Having taken off their shoes, they crept cautiously along the passage.	(already reduced — correct ✓)



04 | HAVING V3 — More Examples

FULL CLAUSE

Because he had been his own boss for such a long time, he found it hard to accept orders.

→ **Having been his own boss for such a long time, he found it hard to accept orders**

NEGATIVE

Not having received any letters from her, I wrote the letter.

→ **Not having received any letters from her, I wrote the letter. (negative perfect)**



KEY: 'Having V3' is the ACTIVE perfect participle.

Use it when the cause happened BEFORE the main clause event.



05 | HAVING BEEN V3 — Passive Perfect Participle



Use 'having been V3' when the subject RECEIVES the action in a passive clause that happened BEFORE the main clause.

Because + S + was/were + V3 (passive) → Having been + V3

1

Having been warned about the bandits, he left his valuables at home.

(After he had been warned...)

2

Having been bitten twice, the postman refused to deliver unless we chained the dog.

(After the dog had bitten him twice...)

3

Having been beaten by the gangsters, John couldn't walk for more than two months.

(After the gangsters had beaten him...)

4

Having been threatened constantly, the little boy complained about the older boys.

(After being threatened constantly...)

06 | ACTIVE vs PASSIVE PERFECT — Side by Side

ACTIVE — Having V3

Having + V3 (subject did the action)

- ✓ Having eaten his dinner, he rushed out.
- ✓ Having read the instructions, he grabbed the extinguisher.
- ✓ Having failed twice, he didn't want to try again.
- ✓ Having taken off their shoes, they crept along the passage.

PASSIVE — Having been V3

Having been + V3 (subject received the action)

- ✓ Having been warned, he left his valuables at home.
- ✓ Having been bitten, the postman refused to deliver.
- ✓ Having been beaten, John couldn't walk for 2 months.
- ✓ Having been threatened, the little boy complained.

07 | COMPLETE SUMMARY TABLE

TYPE	CONJUNCTION	HOW TO REDUCE	FORM	EXAMPLE
Cause (Active)	As/Since/Because While	Remove conj. + subj.	V-ing	Needing money, Sue cashed a check.
Cause (Neg.)	Because (neg.)	Remove conj. + subj.	not + V-ing	Not knowing her number, I can't call.
to be + adj	Since/Because (+ adj)	Remove conj +subj.+be	(being)+Adj	Being suitable, she is lucky.
Perfect (Active)	Because (past)	Remove conj +subj + had	Having V3	Having failed twice, he gave up.
Perfect (Passive)	After (passive)	Remove conj +subj +was/were	Having been V3	Having been warned, he was careful.
If/Unless As if	Unless/As if	Keep conj., remove subj+be	conj.+V3/ing	Unless paid fairly, we strike.



QUIZ 1 | Identify the Reduced Form

Identify each as: V-ing / not+V-ing / having V3 / having been V3 / (being)+adj

1. Having been bitten twice, the postman refused to deliver our letters.

2. Needing some money to buy a book, Sue cashed a check.

3. Not having studied well, she failed the exam.

4. Being suitable for the vacant post, she is lucky.

5. Having eaten his dinner, he rushed out of the house.

QUIZ 1 | ANSWERS

having been V3 (Passive Perfect)

Subject was bitten by the dog — passive. Event happened before refusing.

→ *Subject was bitten by the dog — passive. Event happened before refusing.*

V-ing (Active Cause)

'Because she needed' → remove conj. + subj. → 'Needing'.

→ *'Because she needed' → remove conj. + subj. → 'Needing'.*

not + having V3 (Neg. Perfect)

Negative: 'hadn't studied' → 'not having studied'.

→ *Negative: 'hadn't studied' → 'not having studied'.*

(being) + adjective

'to be + suitable' → 'Being suitable'. 'Being' can be dropped.

→ *'to be + suitable' → 'Being suitable'. 'Being' can be dropped.*

having V3 (Active Perfect)

He ate first, then rushed. Sequence → 'Having eaten'.

→ *He ate first, then rushed. Sequence → 'Having eaten'.*



QUIZ 2 | Reduce the Clause

Rewrite each sentence using the correct reduced form (V-ing / having V3 / having been V3).

1. Because she is a mother now, she has more responsibilities.

2. Because I injured my back yesterday, I now have difficulty walking.

3. Because she hadn't studied well, she failed the exam.

4. Having been threatened constantly by the older boys, the little boy complained.

5. Unless we are paid fairly, we will go on a strike.

QUIZ 2 | ANSWERS

V-ing

Being a mother now, she has more responsibilities.

→ 'Because + is' → 'Being' (to be + noun).

Having V3

Having injured my back yesterday, I now have difficulty.

→ Past event before present → 'Having V3'.

not having V3

Not having studied well, she failed the exam.

→ Negative past → 'Not having V3'.

having been V3

Having been threatened constantly, the little boy complained.

→ Already passive perfect — correct ✓

conj.+V3

Unless paid fairly, we will go on a strike.

→ 'Unless' kept. 'we are' removed → passive V3.



QUIZ 3 | Find & Fix the Mistake

Each sentence has ONE mistake in the reduced form. Find it and correct it.

1. Knowing not her phone number, I can't call her.

2. Having injured her back yesterday, she was difficulty in walking.

3. Not been warned about the bandits, he took all his valuables.

4. Been beaten by the gangsters, John couldn't walk for two months.

5. Unless being paid fairly, we will go on a strike.

QUIZ 3 | ANSWERS

✗ *Knowing not...*

✓ **Not knowing her phone number, I can't call her.**

→ 'not' must come *BEFORE* the participle, not after it.

✗ *she was difficulty...*

✓ **Having injured my back yesterday, I now have difficulty in walking.**

→ 'have difficulty' — not 'was difficulty'. Check the main clause.

✗ *Not been warned...*

✓ **Not having been warned about the bandits, he took all his valuables.**

→ Negative passive perfect: 'not having been V3' — 'been' alone is not enough.

✗ *Been beaten...*

✓ **Having been beaten by the gangsters, John couldn't walk.**

→ Passive perfect needs 'Having been V3' — not 'Been V3' alone.

✗ *Unless being paid...*

✓ **Unless paid fairly, we will go on a strike.**

→ After 'unless' → past participle (V3) directly, no 'being' needed here.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Reduced Adverb Clauses

Cause & Effect + Perfect Participles



Cause conjunctions (As/Since/Because/While) are OMITTED → V-ing

— Negative: NOT comes BEFORE the participle → not+V-ing / not having V3



Earlier event before main clause → Having + V3 (active perfect)



Passive earlier event → Having been + V3 (passive perfect)

Excellent work! Master these and your writing will flow naturally. 